

Sprint Preparation Guide

Getting a head start on your Sprint and begin with confidence.

This is the conversation guide that AJ&Smart uses to have a pre-sprint conversation/interview with the key stakeholder or the person who has initiated the idea of doing a sprint. This list of questions is designed to do two things: give the facilitator some background information so that they can prepare some initial starting points for the early exercises and also to start onboarding the stakeholder and give them an idea of the kind of things they will be thinking about and doing in the Sprint itself. This conversation usually takes around 30 minutes.

Based on the information gathered the facilitator can spend another hour or so quickly drafting an initial idea of potential How Might We (HMW) questions, Long Term Goal and Sprint Questions (Can We...), a rough idea of a Map, and some Lightning Demos, so that when the workshop starts the facilitator can be prepared for each exercise, instead of starting from a blank slate.

Who will the interviewer speak to?

In most cases the Product Manager (PM) / Product Owner (PO), and not the CEO / CPO. However, in order to get buy-in from the PM / PO's bosses after the sprint, we will sometimes frame the questions to "What does your boss want?"

These questions are a guide for starting the interview. We do not always ask all of those questions, however, the highlighted ones are good ones to have the first answers to before the sprint.

It's best if you take your notes directly in the HMW, Can We and Map format during the interview, so you don't need to spend additional time to rewrite those. It also gives you practice for the expert interviews.

Question	Outcome
☐ What are you trying to achieve?	Can lead to HMWs and Long Term Goal
☐ What is the product / service / business? What's the challenge?	Can lead to HMWs and Long Term Goal
☐ Who are the existing customers? Who are the target customers for the sprint? What is the gap between existing and target customers?	Should lead to Target profile for the recruiter
☐ What would you like to know from the end user?	Can lead to Can We questions
☐ What does the typical user journey look like? What's working well, what's not?	Can lead to the first draft of the Map
☐ What are the top 3 questions you would like to have answered in the Sprint?	Can lead to Can We questions, and should be addressed in the final report at the end of the sprint.
☐ What is the project timeline? Where does the sprint fit in? What are key milestones, deadlines? What should happen after the sprint?	This helps to get a better understanding of where the project is currently at and can uncover additional challenges.
☐ What is the current workflow? Who's doing what?	This helps to get a better understanding of where the project is currently at and can uncover additional challenges.
☐ What are the constraints and why? What if there were no constraints?	This helps to get a better understanding of where the project is currently at and can uncover additional challenges.
☐ What are the clients unique opportunities/advantages? Who is their competitor? Which companies are inspiring them?	Can lead to Lightning Demos . Here it is also useful to tell the client to think of Lightning Demos they can present in the Sprint.
☐ When will this project be accepted as a success?	This helps to understand alignment with cross-functional team and where the product fits internally as well as for the market.

❑ What questions does the client have?	This helps you to understand any additional questions the client might have, and most often these revolve around the Sprint process. Here it helps to again give them an overview of the Sprint.
❑ Do they have any artefacts they can show? Please do not let them prepare a slide deck, though!	An existing prototype or existing user journeys can be additional input for the Map